

Tab 1

Indigenous AI - What's going on

Basic idea

SS

Beliefs

- De-biasing existing LLMs w appropriate prompts is not enough
 - First, nudges alignment only 70-80%
 - Next, still doesn't understand cultural nuances
- Current indigenous + AI efforts are focused on *preservation* (eg, languages) and

Research

- Indigenous concepts
 - Relationality/Connectedness
 - [Seventh Generation Principle](#) - the decisions we make today should result in a sustainable world seven generations into the future

Value dimension	Typical Indigenous orientation	Typical Western-industrial orientation	Why it matters in practice
Relationship to land	Land is a living relative to whom people owe reciprocity and care	Land is a resource to be owned or exploited for human benefit	Drives land-based pedagogy and site-first design decisions Indigenous Corporate Training Canadian Commission for UNESCO
Knowledge & learning	Holistic, experiential, story- and place-based, carried by Elders across generations	Abstract, compartmentalised, text-based, validated by formal expertise	Leads to integrated, cross-disciplinary lessons versus subject silos; privileges community history and community mentoring FNESC Indigenous Corporate Training
Time horizon	Cyclical, seasonal; decisions weighed for “7 generations”	Linear, progress-focused; short ROI cycles	Favours seasonal learning rhythms and long-life, low-maintenance buildings Indigenous Corporate Training
Social order & decision-making	Consensus, collective agency, respect for Elders’ authority grounded in lived wisdom	Hierarchical, expert-led, efficiency-driven	Extends project timelines for consultation but increases community ownership dsge.com
Moral economy	Reciprocity, community wellbeing, enoughness	Competition, individual achievement, accumulation	Shifts assessment from individual grade: community impacts; shifts architecture briefs from “signature” to shared spaces Indigenous Corporate Training
Human–nature boundary	Porous—humans are one node in a web of animate relations	Sharp—humans manage or dominate nature	Leads to biophilic design choices and curricula centred on local ecology and stewardship CityChangers
Spiritual dimension	Everyday actions are spiritually consequential; some knowledge is sacred or restricted	Secular—rational; knowledge ideally public and universal	Implies protocols (e.g., ground-blessing ceremonies, restricted content) that Western processes often skip FNESC dsge.com

Use cases

- Designing things. Particularly places where we need community ownership, and resilience, not just efficiency
 - Educational curriculum
 - Construction projects
 - Climate solutions
 - Athlete training (Dr. Ihi)
 - Economic policy
 - Investment portfolio (e.g. a VC feeds the business plan of climate any startup to the LLM)
- S

Questions/Ideas

- This idea is extensible to not just building a “QuechuaLLM” but also a “WhaleLLM”. What does that even mean?
- What is “community-led design” in practice?

- What's the fundamental unit: values or worldviews? Former is captured through the World Values Survey, how would one capture worldviews?
- What's the taxonomy of indigenous peoples that makes sense for us? Grouped by regions? By similarity in worldviews?
- What's the connection, if any, to [systems thinking](#) (ST) and indigenous worldviews? Afterall, of all the pressure points in a complex system, the most powerful is "*The mindset or paradigm out of which the system — its goals, power structure, rules, its culture — arises*"
 - Study how ST became a cottage industry. What kind of tools/schools, who uses it, for what etc? Could be a parallel for us.
- Since the biggest use case is "designing stuff":
 - Get the d.school involved?
 - Should this be used as a "brainstormer/co-designer", or a "critic/advisor"? Latter seems easier to implement
- Where do regenerative principles fit in?
- What does this approach come at the expense of? Time, efficiency, cost, others? What's the evidence that it does/not?
- When creating "indigenous" versions of something, say [a lesson plan on water](#), are we just adding a "cultural" layer on top in addition to all the learning objectives and scientific understanding that a "normal" curriculum would have provided? That just sounds like more work, no?
- Specifically, what is the Quechua worldview?
- One risk: doing this without being indigenous yourself risks being seen as cultural appropriation?

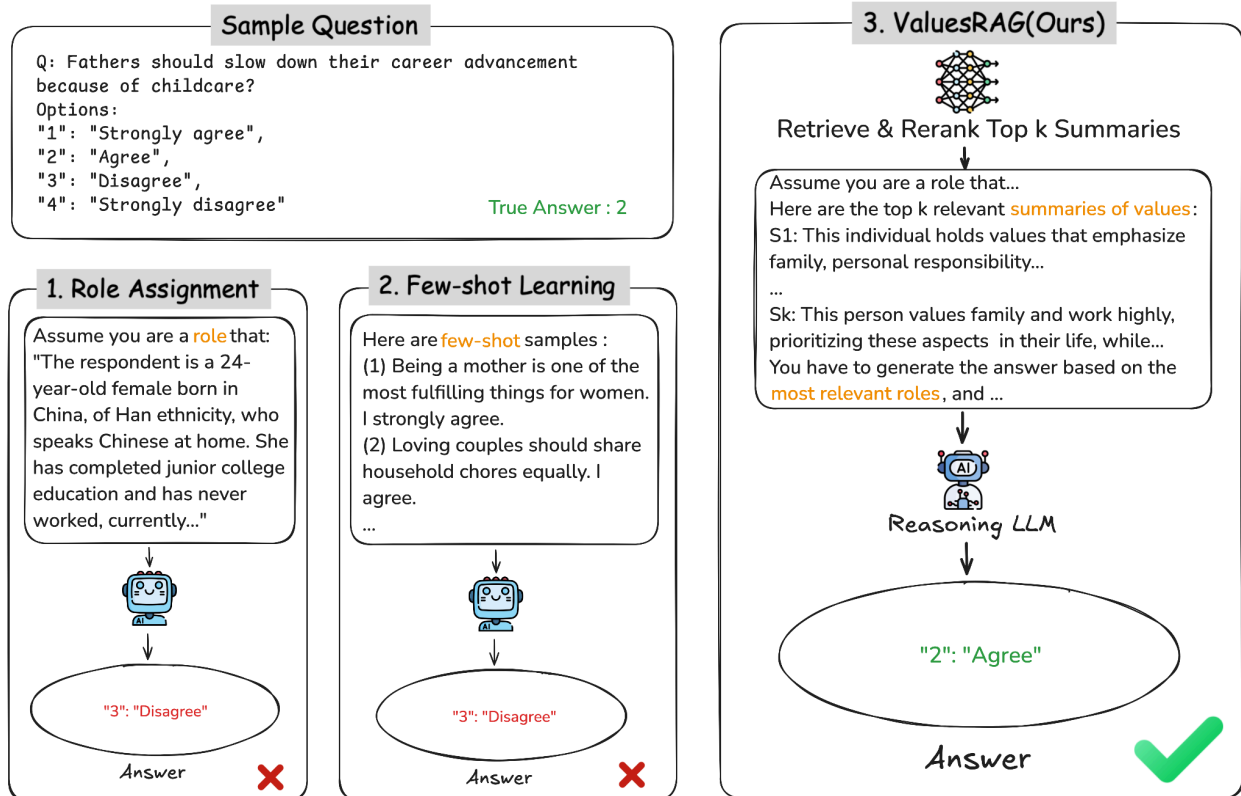
Resources

- [Abundant intelligences: placing AI within Indigenous knowledge frameworks](#)
 - [Leverage points in a system](#) - Donella Meadows
 - [ValuesRAG: Enhancing Cultural Alignment Through Retrieval-Augmented Contextual Learning](#)
 - [Collaboration between Scientists & Lakota leaders gets prestigious best science paper award](#)
 - [Blending Indigenous Knowledge and artificial intelligence to enable adaptation](#)
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Actual Doing

Ss

Debiasing using ValuesRAG



Neva Research

Research

Data Sovereignty: <https://www.gida-global.org/care>

- **CARE Principles:** “any use of data involving Indigenous Peoples must advance collective rights, self-determination, and culturally grounded benefit”
- Note: this will be extremely important down the line, need to establish consent etc. right from the get-go
- **Collective Benefit:** Indig. Data should be used to advance Indig. Communities as collectives; cannot benefit just one researcher/startup/etc.
 - Should be able to be used for community led initiatives
 - Benefits (be it revenue, knowledge/insights, etc.) must come back to the community
- **Authority to Control:** Indig. peoples retain the right to govern who has access to their data and what can be done w/ it, regardless of who actually owns it at any time
 - Legal, cultural, and intellectual-property rights extend to digital data
 - *Free, prior, and informed consent (FPIC)* = mandatory before using any data
 - Metadata should record Indigenous ownership, requires permissions
datascience.codata.org
- **Responsibility:** “duty of care” requires heavy involvement
 - Data users have to document + publicly report on how the data is used
 - Plans must address long-term access and cultural relevance
 - Projects should fund training and technology transfer so communities can manage and analyze their own data
- **Ethics:** work w/ Indigenous data must keep w/ Indigenous values, frameworks, worldviews
 - Should actively try to mitigate risks like misrepresentation
 - Large amount of knowledge is sacred/restricted; have to respect
 - Mechanisms should be in place for communities to contest any data misuse

Using CARE in practice

1. **Embed CARE questions into project design** (Who benefits? Who decides? How is consent refreshed?).
2. **Tag datasets with Indigenous provenance metadata** and, where relevant, **Traditional Knowledge (TK) Labels**.
3. **Share value**: budget for community honoraria, revenue share, or local tech infrastructure.
4. **Review annually** with Indigenous partners to adapt to evolving cultural or legal contexts.

Adopting CARE transforms Indigenous data work from extractive to reciprocal, laying the ethical and legal groundwork for any future AI or knowledge-sharing initiatives. test.repository.oceanbestpractices.org

- Also look into OCAP: [First Nations principles of OCAP - Wikipedia](#)
- “Possession, or stewardship, refers to the physical control of data. It is more concrete than ownership, which identifies the relationship between a people and their information in principle. Possession is the mechanism by which ownership can be asserted and protected.”
- Ownership describes how indig. People own their data even when they don’t have it in possession (goes back to CARE)
- Possession = physical control
- This is different from FAIR Principles which ask if data is findable, accessible, interoperable and reusable (focuses much more on research efficiency)

ValuesRAG

summary: <https://ui.adsabs.harvard.edu/abs/2025arXiv250101031S/abstract>

Full paper: arxiv.org

- Goal of ValuesRAG is to fix the Western-centric bias of LLMs by injecting community-specific value statements as the LLM is “thinking”
- Uses the World Values Survey and each respondent’s answers are compressed into a short **value blurb** (e.g., *high collectivism, low materialism*)
- a user asks a question, the system retrieves blurbs whose demographics (age, region, religion, etc.) match the persona
- The chosen blurbs are added onto/modify the user prompt
- Result: on culture-sensitive Q&A tasks, values-aligned accuracy jumps by 21% over role-play (“imagine you are XXX”)

Indigenous Values vs. Western Values

- <https://www.queensu.ca/indigenous/ways-knowing/about>
- <https://opentextbc.ca/indigenizationcurriculumdevelopers/chapter/indigenous-epistemologies-and-pedagogies/>
- Two eyed seeing: approach to knowledge and learning that combines Indigenous and Western perspectives
- https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Two-Eyed_Seeing

#	Source & context	Core Indigenous epistemological stance (what "counts" as knowledge)	Typical Western scientific stance (contrast)	Salient difference in values
1	Willie Ermine, "Aboriginal Epistemology" (Cree, 1995) dialnet.unirioja.es	Knowledge is <i>inner-generated</i> through introspection, spirit, and lived relationship with all beings; truth is relational and experiential.	Knowledge is discovered externally , verified by detached observation; spirit kept separate from "objective" fact.	Relational/holistic vs. objectified/analytic
2	Albert & Murdena Marshall et al., "Two-Eyed Seeing" framework (Mi'kmaq, 2012) researchgate.net	Hold Indigenous and Western "ways of knowing" in balance ; each valued for its strengths (responsibility, long-term reciprocity, land-based insight).	Positivist hierarchy that historically dismisses non-empirical knowledge and privileges quantitative proof.	Complementarity & respect vs. dominance of a single epistemic lens
3	Shawn Wilson, <i>Research Is Ceremony</i> (Opaskwayak Cree, 2008) fernwoodpublishing.ca	Research is a <i>ceremonial act of relational accountability</i> —scholar is responsible to all their relations (human, non-human, past & future).	Researcher seeks neutrality; relationship with subject is minimised to reduce "bias."	Accountability to relationships vs. detachment for objectivity
4	Gregory Cajete, <i>Native Science</i> (Tewa, 2000) outdoorlearning.com	Nature and humans are co-creators in an interdependent universe; knowledge is validated by how well it sustains ecological harmony.	Human observer is separate from nature; success measured by predictive control and technological utility.	Interdependence & stewardship vs. separation & control
5	Linda Tuhiwai Smith, <i>Decolonizing Methodologies</i> (Ngāti Awa, 1999 / 2019) bloomsbury.com	Research must advance Indigenous self-determination; communities decide purpose, methods, and benefit-sharing.	Knowledge production often embedded in colonial extraction; subjects rarely shape agenda or gain direct benefits.	Self-determination & ethical reciprocity vs. external extraction & academic ownership
6	"Indigenous Epistemologies & Pedagogies" guide (multiple scholars, 2018) opentextbc.ca	Emphasises relationality, spirituality, and holism (emotional, spiritual, cognitive, physical dimensions inseparable).	Curriculum centres cognitive domain; spirituality bracketed out as "non-academic."	Whole-person learning vs. mind-body/sacred-secular split

Implementation

- Value of collecting 50-100 testimonies vs. just creating a fake backend
- a. Depth of reference: prompt like “*You are a Lakota Elder ...*” relies on whatever slim Lakota data the base model already has access to; often creates clichés
- b. transparency: can cite every passage the model draws on + can also remove or amend excerpts instantly
- Tagging testimonies by value (reciprocity, kinship to land, etc.) lets the engine find multiple perspectives while a single persona prompt risks collapsing many diff. perspectives
- Would there actually be a big difference in cultural alignment?

Approach	Pros	Cons	Where it shines
Role-play prompt “You are a Lakota elder who...”	Zero setup; anyone can try.	Depends on pre-training; often stereotypes; no citations.	Quick sanity checks.
ValuesRAG-style retrieval (testimonies live in a small database)	Keeps raw testimonies outside the model; citations; low compute; easy to update.	Still needs good tagging & retrieval logic; answers vanish if retrieval fails.	Great first milestone once you’ve collected/consented 50–100 transcripts.
Fine-tuning / LoRA on testimonies	Nuance is baked into weights; works offline or when retrieval breaks.	Higher cost; harder to audit/remove content; thornier IP questions.	Long-term, once corpus & governance are stable.

Questions:

- Which specific community groups can I make authentic connections w/? Their incentive?
- What concrete benefit will the participating communities see within 12 months? (policy influence maybe?)
- How do I actually get consent for each testimony/story/audio clip, etc.?
- For testimonies, focusing on one domain at first (eg. climate, eg. policy) or starting off broader? (which is where we want to get to eventually, of course)
- How to decide whether an AI answer is “aligned” with worldview values? Some sort of vetting system, maybe asking elders?
- Again, **incentive**?

- Safeguards to prevent testimony set from flattening perspectives?
- Resources? What part of this will need actual money?
- Honoraria payment for consulting elders? Is that tacky?
- How do you judge between objective truth and just being aligned w/ certain values?
- Want to rebias, not debias - so maybe just no objective truth?

2 Pager

Indigenous Reasoning x AI Overview

1. Problem

For better or worse, AI models are being used to design our world - both digital and material. And yet, their worldviews are limited to Western-centric views like short term optimization or efficiency because of how they were trained. We're missing out on different and extremely powerful ways of thinking, especially with Indigenous worldviews. Indigenous knowledge stems from completely non-mainstream ideas of reciprocity, land kinship and responsibility to the natural world, and we have an opportunity to re-introduce this wisdom across cultures and millenia into the design of our future systems. As AI becomes embedded in policy, design, education, and storytelling, this project asks how we can shift the way it shapes our world. That's the radical project this effort is hoping to kickstart!

2. Where this work matters

Design: From urban planning to UX, Indigenous reasoning offers frameworks that prioritize long-term consequences, land relationships, and collective care.

Governance: Policy models rooted in Indigenous knowledge emphasize stewardship rather than extraction, making them crucial to sustainable climate, land, and welfare systems.

Culture & education: Storytelling, curricula, and cultural AI tools benefit from new worldviews.

3. Our approach

We're building a set of AI tools that incorporate Indigenous wisdom—for example, circular cause-and-effect or planning seven generations ahead—into its answers. The common platform for these tools would take into account community ownership, data sovereignty, tagging infrastructure etc. And when this platform is built, we imagine this being opened up for people (e.g. through hackathons) to build tools on top of this.

Key steps

- Agree on consent and shared-benefit terms with three partner Nations (?)
 - Record ~100 focused conversations on real decision situations
 - Tag each excerpt with 6–8 clear reasoning labels checked by community reviewers
 - Build a first demo that adds these excerpts to a standard model; later fine-tune an open model
-

4. Near-Term Milestones (AI Suggested)

Time frame	Goal
Summer 2025	Partners signed, tagging scheme finished, 40 testimonies recorded, retrieval demo online.
Fall 2025	Corpus ~300 k words, pilots with one design studio and one policy group, short methods paper submitted.
Summer 2026	Beta of fine-tuned Indigenous-reasoning model, limited API released to designer and policy cohorts.

Outreach

People papa has to contact: Belen, Seth, Jan, Amanda, Jose, Josie, Louise, Pat, Ruth

Papa email template: adjust based on level of closeness etc

Hey X,

Hope you're doing well! [I] Wanted to reach out because my daughter, Neva, is working on a pretty ambitious project that I thought you might find interesting - she's been exploring the question of what AI models would look like if they reflected Indigenous worldviews and reasoning systems instead of Western ones. She's hoping to talk to a bunch of experts and write a whitepaper by the end of the summer. She'd love to chat with you if you're up for it - even a quick call sometime in the next few weeks would be amazing. I'll paste a short note from her below with more context.

Best,
Anshuman

From Neva:

Hi [name here]! As my dad mentioned, I'm working on a project looking at how we might reimagine the foundations of AI by training it on Indigenous knowledge systems, not just Western logic or data. This summer, I'm interviewing people across the fields of AI, epistemology, Indigenous data governance, and design, as well as writing a white paper.

I plan on researching Indigenous data sovereignty deeply to make sure nothing I do/publish ends up being extractive, which is why I need to talk to people like you! Since you're familiar with the field of [field here], and have [done, worked on XXX], I feel like you'd be able to provide some really valuable insight. I would be so grateful for a 20–30 minute call to ask some questions and get your perspective.

[Here](#) is a quick overview of the project. Thank you so much!

Warmly,

Neva

nevabapna@gmail.com

<https://calendly.com/nevabapna/quick-chat>

Belén:

Hey Belén,

Hope you're doing well! I wanted to reach out because my daughter, Neva, is working on a pretty ambitious project that I thought you might find interesting - she's been exploring the question of what AI models would look like if they reflected Indigenous worldviews and reasoning systems instead of Western ones. She's hoping to talk to a bunch of experts and write a whitepaper by the end of the summer. She'd love to chat with you if you're up for it - even a quick call sometime in the next few weeks would be amazing. I'll paste a short note from her below with more context.

Best,
Anshuman

From Neva:

Hi Belén! As my dad mentioned, I'm working on a project looking at how we might reimagine the foundations of AI by training it on Indigenous knowledge systems, not just Western logic or data. This summer, I'm interviewing people across the fields of AI, epistemology, Indigenous data governance, and design, as well as writing a white paper.

I plan on researching Indigenous data sovereignty deeply to make sure nothing I do/publish ends up being extractive, which is why I was hoping to talk to you! Since you've worked so closely with Indigenous communities in Ecuador & Perú through Fundación Pachamama, I feel like you'd be able to provide some really valuable insight. I would be so grateful for a 20–30 minute call to ask some questions and get your perspective. Please let me know what times might work for you. If it's easier, here's my calendar: <https://calendly.com/nevabapna/quick-chat>
[Here](#) is a quick overview of the project. Thank you so much!

Warmly,
Neva
nevabapna@gmail.com

Jan:

Hey Jan,

Hope you're doing well! I wanted to reach out because my daughter, Neva, is working on a pretty ambitious project that I thought you might find interesting - she's been exploring the question of what AI models would look like if they reflected Indigenous worldviews and reasoning systems instead of Western ones. She's hoping to talk to a bunch of experts and write a whitepaper by the end of the summer. She'd love to chat with you if you're up for it - even a quick call sometime in the next few weeks would be amazing. I'll paste a short note from her below with more context.

Best,
Anshuman

From Neva:

Hi Jan! As my dad mentioned, I'm working on a project looking at how we might reimagine the foundations of AI by training it on Indigenous knowledge systems, not just Western logic or data. This summer, I'm interviewing people across the fields of AI, epistemology, Indigenous data governance, and design, as well as writing a white paper.

I plan on researching Indigenous data sovereignty deeply to make sure nothing I do/publish ends up being extractive, which is why I was hoping to talk to you! Since you specialize in combining Indigenous wisdom with more mainstream frontier technology, I feel like you'd be able to provide some really valuable insight. I would be so grateful for a 20–30 minute call to ask some questions and get your perspective. Please let me know what times might work for you. If it's easier, here's my calendar: <https://calendly.com/nevabapna/quick-chat>
[Here](#) is a quick overview of the project. Thank you so much!

Warmly,
Neva
nevabapna@gmail.com

Amanda:

Hey Amanda,

Hope you're doing well! I wanted to reach out because my daughter, Neva, is working on a pretty ambitious project that I thought you might find interesting - she's been exploring the question of what AI models would look like if they reflected Indigenous worldviews and reasoning systems instead of Western ones. She's hoping to talk to a bunch of experts and write a whitepaper by the end of the summer. She'd love to chat with you if you're up for it - even a quick call sometime in the next few weeks would be amazing. I'll paste a short note from her below with more context.

Best,
Anshuman

From Neva:

Hi Amanda! As my dad mentioned, I'm working on a project looking at how we might reimagine the foundations of AI by training it on Indigenous knowledge systems, not just Western logic or data. This summer, I'm interviewing people across the fields of AI, epistemology, Indigenous data governance, and design, as well as writing a white paper.

I plan on researching Indigenous data sovereignty deeply to make sure nothing I do/publish ends up being extractive, which is why I was hoping to talk to you! Given your leadership at the Buckminster Fuller Institute and now with the Museum of TMRW, I feel like your systems thinking approach would be incredibly helpful in the shaping of this project. I would be so grateful for a 20–30 minute call to ask some questions and get your perspective. Please let me know what times might work for you. If it's easier, here's my calendar:

<https://calendly.com/nevabapna/quick-chat>

[Here](#) is a quick overview of the project. Thank you so much!

Warmly,
Neva
nevabapna@gmail.com

Jose:

Hey Jose,

Hope you're doing well! I wanted to reach out because my daughter, Neva, is working on a pretty ambitious project that I thought you might find interesting - she's been exploring the question of what AI models would look like if they reflected Indigenous worldviews and reasoning systems instead of Western ones. She's hoping to talk to a bunch of experts and write a whitepaper by the end of the summer. She'd love to chat with you if you're up for it - even a quick call sometime in the next few weeks would be amazing. I'll paste a short note from her below with more context.

Best,
Anshuman

From Neva:

Hi Jose! As my dad mentioned, I'm working on a project looking at how we might reimagine the foundations of AI by training it on Indigenous knowledge systems, not just Western logic or data. This summer, I'm interviewing people across the fields of AI, epistemology, Indigenous data governance, and design, as well as writing a white paper.

I plan on researching Indigenous data sovereignty deeply to make sure nothing I do/publish ends up being extractive, which is why I was hoping to talk to you! Your work with Native governance feels extremely close to the values this project is trying to uphold, and I'd love to ask how you think something like this should even begin.

I would be so grateful for a 20–30 minute call to ask some questions and get your perspective. Please let me know what times might work for you. If it's easier, here's my calendar:

<https://calendly.com/nevabapna/quick-chat>

[Here](#) is a quick overview of the project. Thank you so much!

Warmly,
Neva
nevabapna@gmail.com

Josie:

Hey Josie,

Hope you're doing well! I wanted to reach out because my daughter, Neva, is working on a pretty ambitious project that I thought you might find interesting - she's been exploring the question of what AI models would look like if they reflected Indigenous worldviews and reasoning systems instead of Western ones. She's hoping to talk to a bunch of experts and write a whitepaper by the end of the summer. She'd love to chat with you if you're up for it - even a quick call sometime in the next few weeks would be amazing. I'll paste a short note from her below with more context.

Best,
Anshuman

From Neva:

Hi Josie! As my dad mentioned, I'm working on a project looking at how we might reimagine the foundations of AI by training it on Indigenous knowledge systems, not just Western logic or data. This summer, I'm interviewing people across the fields of AI, epistemology, Indigenous data governance, and design, as well as writing a white paper.

I plan on researching Indigenous data sovereignty deeply to make sure nothing I do/publish ends up being extractive, which is why I was hoping to talk to you! Given your background in regenerative legal design, I feel like you'd be able to provide some really valuable insight on both the promises and the dangers of embedding cultural logic into tech systems.

I would be so grateful for a 20–30 minute call to ask some questions and get your perspective. Please let me know what times might work for you. If it's easier, here's my calendar:

<https://calendly.com/nevabapna/quick-chat>

[Here](#) is a quick overview of the project. Thank you so much!

Warmly,
Neva
nevabapna@gmail.com

Louise: not sure how connected this project is to her work; may need to research further before sending an email

Pat:

Hey Pat,

Hope you're doing well! I wanted to reach out because my daughter, Neva, is working on a pretty ambitious project that I thought you might find interesting - she's been exploring the question of what AI models would look like if they reflected Indigenous worldviews and reasoning systems instead of Western ones. She's hoping to talk to a bunch of experts and write a whitepaper by the end of the summer. She'd love to chat with you if you're up for it - even a quick call sometime in the next few weeks would be amazing. I'll paste a short note from her below with more context.

Best,
Anshuman

From Neva:

Hi Pat! As my dad mentioned, I'm working on a project looking at how we might reimagine the foundations of AI by training it on Indigenous knowledge systems, not just Western logic or data. This summer, I'm interviewing people across fields, as well as writing a white paper.

I plan on researching Indigenous data sovereignty deeply to make sure nothing I do/publish ends up being extractive, and instead benefits those it's inspired by. I was hoping to talk to you to better understand what thoughtful and respectful engagement should look like in a project like this. I would be incredibly grateful for the opportunity to ask a few questions and to learn from you.

If you'd be open to a short call, please let me know what times might work for you. If it's easier, here's my calendar: <https://calendly.com/nevabapna/quick-chat>
[Here](#) is a quick overview of the project. Thank you so much!

Warmly,
Neva
nevabapna@gmail.com

Ruth: not sure if work is connected enough for it to make sense to reach out at this point

Cold outreach template (running list of good contacts here:

https://docs.google.com/spreadsheets/d/1M4bXTx4_43MlczQQ2Mi8kMmOqtMYs2-VVw804tZ5D0o/edit?usp=sharing)

Hi [XX],

My name is Neva, and I'm exploring what AI systems might look like if they were grounded in Indigenous reasoning.

I know your work in [XX field/topic] brings a really unique and valuable perspective to the questions I'm exploring, and I'd really appreciate the opportunity to ask a few questions and learn from your experience.

[For profs/researchers: optional to mention some study etc. they've published and mention how it's related to my work]

[For indigenous people + people working in data sovereignty: I'm approaching this work with as much humility as I can, and I'm trying to be mindful of not being extractive. That's why I'd be grateful to speak with you and better understand what thoughtful and respectful engagement should look like in a project like this!]

Please let me know what times might work for you. If it's easier, here's my calendar:

<https://calendly.com/nevabapna/quick-chat>

[Here's](#) a short overview of the project if you're interested!

Thank you so much for considering - I really appreciate your time.

Warmly,

Neva Bapna

Palo Alto High School

nevabapna@gmail.com

Contact List with Personalization

1. Dr. Jason Edward Lewis

Affiliation: Concordia University

Email: jason.lewis@concordia.ca

Why: Indigenous Protocol + AI Working Group

Line:

I've been going through the Indigenous Protocol paper, and the framing around relational AI really stuck with me.

2. Dr. Maui Hudson

Affiliation: University of Waikato

Email: maui.hudson@waikato.ac.nz

Why: CARE Principles + Māori Data Sovereignty

Line:

I've been looking closely at the CARE Principles — they've been really helpful in grounding my thinking around ethical data infrastructure.

3. Jane Anderson

Affiliation: NYU / Local Contexts

Email: jane.anderson@nyu.edu

Why: IP + TK Labels

Line:

The TK Labels you helped design were eye-opening for me — I'd love to understand how similar ideas might apply in AI contexts.

4. Dr. Stephanie Carroll

Affiliation: University of Arizona / GIDA

Email: scarroll@arizona.edu

Why: Global Indigenous Data Alliance

Line:

Your leadership at GIDA and the work on CARE has really helped me understand what respectful data governance could look like in this space.

5. Amelia Winger-Bearskin

Affiliation: University of Florida / Wampum.Codes

Email: awbearskin@ufl.edu

Why: AI design, art, Haudenosaunee tech

Line:

I recently found your Wampum.Codes work and it's helped me reimagine how ethical systems could be built into design.

6. Krystal Tsosie

Affiliation: Arizona State University

Email: Krystal.Tsosie@asu.edu

Why: Data sovereignty, ethics

Line:

I've just started exploring your work and it's already challenged how I think about what respectful engagement looks like.

7. Michael Running Wolf

Affiliation: McGill University

Email: [currently private — use LinkedIn or institutional site]

Why: Lakota voice AI

Line:

I've just started looking into your voice AI work — it's already expanding how I think about language and community in AI.

8. Caroline Running Wolf

Affiliation: Indigenous XR researcher

Email: [use LinkedIn / co-project email with Michael]

Why: Immersive tech + language

Line:

I'm just starting to look into your work and I'm especially interested in how your design choices reflect Indigenous worldview.

9. Professor Tahu Kukutai

Affiliation: University of Waikato

Email: takutai@waikato.ac.nz

Why: Māori Data Sovereignty co-founder

Line:

I've just started reviewing your work and it's already shaping how I think about collective rights and data governance.

10. Dr. Noelani Arista

Affiliation: McGill University

Email: noelani.arista@mcgill.ca

Why: Hawaiian knowledge + AI

Line:

I've just started looking into your digital archive work and it's opened up new ways for me to think about culturally informed AI systems.

11. Dr. Linda Tuhiwai Smith

Affiliation: Awanuiārangi

Email: [likely not public — seek intro via Maui Hudson]

Why: *Decolonizing Methodologies*

Line:

Decolonizing Methodologies was one of the first things I encountered when I started this project — I'd be so grateful to speak with you, even briefly.

12. Dr. Michelle Lee Brown

Affiliation: Washington State University

Email: michelle.brown@wsu.edu

Why: Indigenous decolonial HCI

Line:

I've just started exploring your work on decolonial design and it's already helped me think differently about how AI systems engage with knowledge systems.

13. Dr. Jelena Porsanger

Affiliation: Sámi Museum / University of Helsinki

Email: jelena.porsanger@helsinki.fi

Why: Sámi archives, digitization ethics

Line:

I've just started reading about your work with Sámi digital heritage and I'd love to hear more about what careful engagement with AI might look like there.

14. Dr. Geri Augusto

Affiliation: Brown University

Email: geri_augusto@brown.edu

Why: Epistemic justice, Global South tech

Line:

I've just started reading your work and it's already helping me reframe questions of epistemic justice in AI design.

15. Dr. Kimberly Christen

Affiliation: WSU / Mukurtu CMS

Email: kachristen@wsu.edu

Why: Digital archives w/ Indigenous protocols

Line:

I've just started exploring your work on Mukurtu and it's already shaping how I think about designing culturally-grounded digital systems.

16. David Hidalgo

Affiliation: Ojo Público (Peru)

Email: [search via Ojo Público site or Twitter DM]

Why: AI news in Quechua

Line:

I've just started looking into Quispe Chequea — it's one of the most creative and community-driven AI projects I've seen.

17. Professor Alan Blackwell

Affiliation: University of Cambridge

Email: afb21@cam.ac.uk

Why: Global AI narratives + cross-cultural design

Line:

I've just started reading your work on global AI narratives and it's already helped me rethink some core assumptions in the field.

18. Dr. Thomas Mullaney

Affiliation: Stanford University

Email: mullaney@stanford.edu

Why: Digital exclusion + writing systems

Line:

Your work with SILICON helped me think differently about language access in digital spaces — I'd love to connect more.

20. Dr. Carol Zavaleta-Cortijo

Affiliation: Universidad Peruana Cayetano Heredia

Email: [search via Peruvian research portals or ResearchGate]

Why: Works with Quechua communities

Line:

I've just started learning about your work in the Sacred Valley, and I'd love to hear your take on how to build respectful, non-extractive projects in this space.
